

THE TWO FUTURES

An extension to The Manifesto — 15 September 2026

I don't know which version of myself is waiting for me.

So I am going to look directly at both.

PATH I — SHE LIVES

THE MORNING AFTER THE FEAR

One day, I wake up and she's okay.

Not perfectly okay.

Not magically cured.

But alive.

Still here.

Still talking.

Still sending me stupid reels.

Still yapping about things that probably don't matter.

Still annoying me in exactly the way I secretly love.

And I realize something terrifying:

I almost lost the person who made me want to become peaceful.

For months I had been preparing myself for a future without her.

I had imagined becoming colder.

Harder.

More narcissistic.

More ruthless.

I had imagined turning all my love into hatred because hatred seemed easier to carry.

But she survived.

And suddenly that entire future becomes unnecessary.

The monster I had been preparing doesn't have to be born.

I DON'T BECOME SOFT AGAIN

I don't go back to being the innocent kid.

That version of me is gone.

I don't become naive.

I don't stop being ambitious.

I don't stop wanting power.

I don't stop wanting to become exceptional.

I don't stop carrying darkness.

But I finally understand what it was for.

My darkness was never supposed to become my identity.

It was supposed to become my fuel.

My anger becomes discipline.

My envy becomes direction.

My competitiveness becomes excellence.

My pride becomes standards.

My ego becomes confidence without entitlement.

My self-hatred becomes self-awareness without self-destruction.

My desire for revenge becomes something stranger:

I become so good at building my life that the people who once made me feel worthless become irrelevant.

That is the revenge I can live with.

I BUILD

I train.

I eat.

I sleep.

I work.

I create.

I make videos.

I build the channels.

I build the identity.

I build the money.

I build the body.

I build the mind.

But this time I don't destroy myself in the process.

I learned that lesson already.

I don't need to be half-dead to prove I'm disciplined.

I don't need to suffer every second to deserve success.

I don't need to hate myself to improve.

I can want more while being grateful for what I already have.

I LOVE HER DIFFERENTLY

Before the diagnosis, I thought loving someone meant imagining a future with them.

After the diagnosis, I understand that love is also being grateful for today.

I stop taking her existence for granted.

Every call matters.

Every stupid conversation matters.

Every ordinary day becomes extraordinary because I know how quickly ordinary life can disappear.

I don't worship her.

I don't make her responsible for my happiness.

I don't turn her into my entire identity.

I love her while remaining myself.

That's the difference.

I want to build a life with her.

Not build my entire existence around her.

THE BOY INSIDE ME

Sometimes I remember the kid I used to be.

The one who cried.

The one who couldn't fight.

The one who was scared to speak.

The one who barely played.

The one who didn't know how to protect himself.

And instead of hating him, I finally understand him.

He wasn't pathetic.

He was a child.

He survived long enough to become me.

I don't need to murder every old version of myself anymore.

Some of them deserve to be understood.

THE MAN I BECOME

I become dangerous in a different way.

Not because people fear me.

Because I am difficult to control.

I don't need approval.

I don't need revenge.

I don't need to prove every insult wrong.

I don't need to dominate every room.

I don't need to win every argument.

I can walk away.

That's real power.

I become the man who could destroy himself but chooses to build.

The man who has darkness but doesn't worship it.

The man who can feel enormous anger without becoming its servant.

The man who can love deeply without becoming weak.

The man who can lose without losing himself.

And maybe years later, I read this document beside her.

Maybe she's sitting next to me.

Maybe she's laughing.

Maybe she asks why the hell I wrote something so dramatic.

And I laugh too.

Because the future I feared never happened.

PATH II — SHE DOESN'T MAKE IT

THE PHONE CALL

There is a version of this story I don't want to write.

But I'm writing it anyway.

The phone rings.

Or maybe it doesn't.

Maybe the message comes.

Maybe the words are short.

Maybe they're painfully ordinary.

She's gone.

And suddenly the entire universe becomes divided into:

Before her.

and

After her.

For a few seconds, I don't understand it.

Then my body understands before my mind does.

My chest collapses.

My hands shake.

My stomach turns.

My brain rejects the information.

I stare at the screen.

I reread it.

Again.

Again.

Again.

As if reading it differently could change reality.

It doesn't.

She's gone.

THE FIRST DAYS

I don't become a monster immediately.

That's not how it works.

First, I become empty.

I stop caring about things that used to matter.

YouTube?

Who cares.

Looks?

Who cares.

Money?

Who cares.

Girls?

Absolutely fucking not.

The future we planned is gone.

The trips.

The home.

The marriage.

The children.

The stupid conversations.

Her voice.

All of it exists now only inside my memory.

And memory becomes torture.

Because I can still hear someone who no longer exists in my world.

THE ANGER

Eventually, sadness becomes anger.

And anger feels better.

Sadness makes me helpless.

Anger makes me feel alive.

So I begin feeding it.

I replay everything.

Why her?

Why me?

Why did this happen?

Why couldn't medicine save her?

Why did God let this happen?

Why did life give me something beautiful just to threaten taking it away?

I start searching for something to blame.

A person.

A system.

God.

Fate.

Myself.

Anything.

Because accepting that something horrible can happen without someone being responsible is almost impossible for an angry mind.

I want the universe to answer me.

It doesn't.

THE OLD DARKNESS RETURNS

The darkness I once described as a "core" comes back.

But now it has a corpse-sized hole inside it.

The self-hatred returns.

The envy returns.

The pride becomes sharper.

The competitiveness becomes pathological.

The need to prove myself becomes enormous.

I stop wanting to be successful because success feels good.

I want success because I want to scream at the universe:

YOU DIDN'T BREAK ME.

I work harder.

I train harder.

I become more obsessed.

More controlled.

More emotionally distant.

People start noticing.

They tell me:

"You've changed."

I know.

THE EMOTIONAL ARMOR

I stop opening up.

Never again.

That's what I tell myself.

Never again will someone have that much access to me.

Never again will I let another person become important enough to destroy me.

I become suspicious of love.

Someone likes me?

I wonder what they want.

Someone gets close?

I pull away.

Someone tells me they love me?

I think:

You don't know what you're saying.

Because I know exactly what love costs.

And I don't want to pay again.

THE DARK VERSION

This is the version of myself I was afraid of.

He doesn't cry.

He doesn't beg.

He doesn't need anyone.

He walks into rooms with an enormous ego.

He doesn't chase validation.

He doesn't ask permission.

He doesn't care what people think.

He becomes extremely ambitious.

Extremely disciplined.

Extremely competitive.

Extremely difficult to emotionally reach.

People may even admire him.

Some may fear him.

Some may find him magnetic.

And from the outside, it might look like:

He became unstoppable.

But inside?

Something is missing.

THE COST

He won.

That's the problem.

He actually won.

The body.

The money.

The status.

The audience.

The confidence.

The competence.

The recognition.

Everything the younger version of him wanted.

And yet sometimes, alone at night, he remembers a girl talking endlessly on a video call.

And suddenly none of it feels sufficient.

Because the darkest irony is this:

He became everything he thought he needed to become after losing the person who taught him that he didn't need to become a monster.

WHEN REVENGE BECOMES AN IDENTITY

The dangerous point isn't when I become angry.

Anger is human.

The dangerous point is when anger becomes my reason for existing.

When every achievement becomes a message.

Every victory becomes proof.

Every relationship becomes a transaction.

Every person becomes either useful, irrelevant, or threatening.

When I stop asking:

"What do I want?"

and start asking:

"How can I make sure nobody ever has power over me again?"

That's when the darkness wins.

Because now I'm no longer building a life.

I'm building armor.

And armor can become a prison.

THE MONSTER DOESN'T LOOK LIKE A MONSTER

That's the part I need to remember.

The future monster doesn't necessarily scream.

He doesn't necessarily commit some spectacular evil act.

He might be successful.

Polite.

Well-dressed.

Intelligent.

Funny.

Charismatic.

Disciplined.

He might help people occasionally.

He might even convince himself he's a good person.

But internally, he's become incapable of genuine softness.

He doesn't trust.

He doesn't surrender.

He doesn't forgive.

He doesn't love without calculating the potential loss.

He has turned his heart into a fortress.

Nothing gets in.

Nothing gets out.

And he calls that strength.

THE MOMENT OF TRUTH

Eventually, something happens.

Maybe years later.

Someone genuinely cares about me.

Not because of my appearance.

Not because of my money.

Not because of my audience.

Not because of my status.

They simply care.

And for the first time in years, I feel something familiar.

Warmth.

Fear.

The same fear I felt before.

The instinct says:

Destroy it before it can destroy you.

The ego says:

You don't need anyone.

The darkness says:

Never again.

But somewhere underneath all of that is the 21-year-old who wrote this manifesto.

The one who loved a girl enough to become terrified of what losing her might turn him into.

And I remember:

She didn't make me weak.

She proved I could love.

And maybe that's the final battle.

Not against another person.

Not against society.

Not against God.

Against the part of myself that believes pain gives me permission to stop being human.

THE TWO VERSIONS

There may be a light version of me.

There may be a dark version.

But neither is predetermined.

The difference isn't whether I experience tragedy.

The difference is what I do with it.

One turns pain into creation.

The other turns pain into identity.

One becomes strong.

The other becomes hard.

One uses darkness.

The other worships it.

One remembers why he wanted power.

The other forgets.

IF SHE DIES, I AM ALLOWED TO GRIEVE

I don't need to immediately become productive.

I don't need to turn grief into some cinematic transformation.

I don't need to prove that I'm strong.

I can fucking cry.

I can miss her.

I can hate what happened.

I can scream at God.

I can have days where I don't know what the point is.

None of that makes me weak.

The boy who cried when he was bullied wasn't weak.

The 21-year-old who cried for three days wasn't weak.

The man who cries because he lost someone he loved isn't weak.

He is grieving.

AND THEN I GET UP

Eventually.

Not tomorrow.

Maybe not next week.

Maybe not next month.

But eventually.

I get up.

I train again.

I eat again.

I create again.

I laugh again.

I work again.

I live again.

Not because I stopped loving her.

Because I didn't.

I live because she was part of my life, not the entirety of my existence.

And if I ever build something extraordinary after her, I won't pretend she had nothing to do with it.

She changed me.

She showed me a version of myself I didn't know existed.

She made the devil peaceful for a while.

Maybe that is enough to matter forever.

THE REAL DARK VARIANT

The darkest version of me isn't the one who becomes violent.

It isn't the one who hurts people.

It isn't the one who destroys everything.

That's easy.

The truly terrifying version is the one who becomes empty.

The one who succeeds at everything and feels nothing.

The one who gets everything he wanted and still cannot experience it.

The one who turns love into weakness.

The one who turns trust into stupidity.

The one who turns kindness into something to mock.

The one who becomes so afraid of being hurt again that he eliminates the possibility of being loved again.

That is the monster I actually need to watch for.

Because I don't want to win a war against the world and lose the ability to enjoy being alive.

THE CHOICE

So if the day comes when I lose her—

I will not promise that I will remain the same.

I won't.

She changed me.

Losing her would change me again.

Maybe permanently.

But I make one promise:

I will not let grief make decisions that belong to me.

I will not turn pain into permission.

I will not turn anger into a religion.

I will not make cruelty my personality.

I will not confuse emotional numbness with strength.

I will not destroy the remaining pieces of myself simply because one beautiful piece was taken away.

And I will not dishonor the love I had by becoming someone incapable of love.

THE FINAL IMAGE

There are two men standing at the end of these paths.

One stands beside the woman he prayed would survive.

He is older.

Stronger.

Scarred.

Still ambitious.

Still dark.

Still himself.

But peaceful.

The other stands alone.

Also older.

Also strong.

Maybe more successful.

Maybe more feared.

Maybe more powerful.

But his eyes are different.

He has everything except the ability to feel what everything is worth.

Both men were created from the same boy.

Both carried the same darkness.

Both experienced the same potential tragedy.

The difference was not the darkness.

The difference was who controlled it.

THE LAST CHOICE

If you are reading this years from now, you may know which path happened.

I don't.

Today, on 15 September 2026, I am still standing between them.

My girlfriend is alive.

I am scared.

I am angry.

I am hopeful.

I am grieving a future that hasn't even happened.

And maybe that's the cruelest thing about fear:

It makes us mourn people before life has even taken them.

So I will stop living inside the funeral of a future that hasn't happened.

Today, she's here.

Today, I am here.

Today, there is still a chance.

And until reality tells me otherwise—

I choose life.

I choose her recovery.

I choose love.

I choose ambition.

I choose strength.

I choose discipline.

I choose darkness mastered rather than darkness worshipped.

And if someday the worst happens—

I will grieve.

Then, eventually,

I will stand again.

Not as the monster.

Not as the saint.

Not as the hero.

As myself.

The boy who cried.

The teenager who rebuilt.

The student who nearly destroyed his body trying to prove himself.

The man who learned to love.

The man who was terrified of losing it.

The man who carried darkness.

And the man who finally learned:

I don't have to become evil to become powerful.

I don't have to become cold to become strong.

I don't have to destroy the world because the world destroyed something I loved.

I can carry the darkness.

And still choose what I become.